


MANDATE 2024 | GROUND REPORT

# THWARTED FRANCHISE

**Robertsganj, on the southeastern tip of Uttar Pradesh, is a study in how a coalition of other castes often defeats the aspirations of the majority caste among Dalits—in constituencies reserved for the Scheduled Castes**

*By* **SUNIL MENON** *in Robertsganj, UP* / *Photographs by* **CHANDRADEEP KUMAR**